

Caribe Sur

Costa Rica · southern Caribbean coast · **Mon 5 – Sat 10 October 2026**

Jason & Andrea · Cahuita to Manzanillo · 32 entries, 30 activities

HOME BASES

MON 5 – WED 7 OCT

Dragonfly Beach Retreat — Deluxe Casita

Home base for Oct 5–6. Deluxe Casita, confirmation 4W9K5ZP4QB, paid in full.

- Check-in Oct 5 15:00, check-out Oct 7 11:00
- 100 m from Playa Arrecife and La Sirena
- Ask about on-site couples massage and bikes

Phone / WhatsApp +506 6128 7817

WED 7 – SAT 10 OCT

Congo Bongo EcoVillage — Sweet Dream House

Home base for Oct 7–10. Sweet Dream House, locator 33643575, \$419.51 due at the property.

- Office 07:00–16:00; after 16:00 keys are in the lockbox
- Five minutes on foot to the Gandoca-Manzanillo refuge trail
- Daan can book Sherman's boat directly

Phone / WhatsApp +506 8957 4177

NUMBERS TO HAVE ON PAPER

Dragonfly Beach Retreat	+506 6128 7817	Conf.	4W9K5ZP4QB · paid in full
Congo Bongo — Daan Nelemans	+506 8957 4177	Locator	33643575 · \$419.51 due at property
Adobe Rent a Car, Limón	+506 2758 4042	Car	Pick up Mon 13:30 · return Sat 15:30, full tank (closes 17:00)
Sansa — Limón (LIO)	RZ1102 / RZ1132	Flights	Mon 12:40 arrive · Sat 17:10 depart to SJO
Other numbers	Jaguar Rescue +506 2750 0710 · Kayaks Punta Uva +506 8839 8386 · Beauty Ritual Spa +506 8314 8943 · Green Water Tours +506 6427 7088 · Cacao Trails +506 8353 8455 · Finca la Isla +506 8886 8530		

SIX DAYS AT A GLANCE

DATE	SLEEP	FIXED POINTS	OPTION SETS
Mon Oct 5	Dragonfly	12:40 Land Limón (Sansa RZ1102) 13:30 Adobe Rent a Car pickup 15:00 Dragonfly check-in	Land and float · Stretch the legs
Tue Oct 6	Dragonfly	Open day	Water day · Sloths first · Slow day
Wed Oct 7	Congo Bongo	11:00 Dragonfly checkout 16:00 Congo Bongo office closes	Cocles morning · Cahuita today instead of Saturday · Straight to Manzanillo
Thu Oct 8	Congo Bongo	Open day	Boat day · Hike day · Do both
Fri Oct 9	Congo Bongo	Open day	Waterfall + chocolate · Puerto Viejo only · Stay south
Sat Oct 10	Congo Bongo	07:00 Settle \$419.51 with Congo Bongo 15:30 Adobe return — Limón downtown 16:15 Sansa check-in (LIO) 17:10 Sansa RZ1132 to SJO	Cahuita snorkel + walk · Cahuita walk only · Slow exit

DON'T FORGET

- **TUE OCT 6** La NENA is closed today (Tue).
- **WED OCT 7** La NENA is closed today (Wed).
- **FRI OCT 9** Inland options are ~35 min from Manzanillo.
- **SAT OCT 10** All bags are in the car at Cahuita — paid lot at Kelly Creek, nothing visible.
- **SAT OCT 10** Latest departure from Manzanillo direct to Limón: 13:45.
- **SAT OCT 10** Saturday hours differ: Moca Beach closes 17:00, Rios Vegan closes 12:00.
- **EVERY DAY** Carry cash — card machines are unreliable (Moca Beach, Ma-Cu, Two Waters, kayak rental are cash).
- **BOOK AHEAD** Cahuita reef snorkel (24 h), Sherman's boat (ask Daan the day before), couples massage (WhatsApp a day ahead).

Part I • The coast, north to south

KEY • Nature ◊ Water ◆ Culture ▲ Wellness ◇ Town ■ Eat Drive times are estimates: straight-line distance × 1.3, at 30 km/h.

01 Cahuita

~47 min from Dragonfly / ~56 min from Congo Bongo | 3 entries

NATURE • WATER

• **Cahuita National Park — coastal trail** NATURE

Donation, \$5–10 pp suggested · 2–4 h · No booking needed

HOURS Daily 08:00–16:00 | **BEST** Oct 7, Oct 10

Flat 8 km trail from Kelly Creek (Cahuita village) to Puerto Vargas along the beach and through jungle; the last stretch is a raised boardwalk.

- Sloths, howler and capuchin monkeys
- Raccoons that raid bags
- Punta Cahuita white-sand beach halfway

Note: On a transit day, walk 45–60 min in and turn around. Park in the paid lot by Kelly Creek and leave nothing visible — bags will be in the car.

BOOKING None; guides at the Kelly Creek gate ~\$25 pp

PAIRS WITH Cahuita National Park — reef snorkel by boat; Cahuita village

◊ **Cahuita National Park — reef snorkel by boat** WATER

\$45–55 pp, gear + fruit included · 2–2.5 h · **Book ahead** — Book 24 h ahead

HOURS Daily 08:00–12:00 | **BEST** Oct 7, Oct 10

Ten-minute boat to two reef spots inside the park's 600-hectare marine zone, then a fruit break on Punta Cahuita beach.

- Costa Rica's largest Caribbean reef
- Sea turtles, rays, nurse sharks on the sand, parrotfish
- Sep–Oct is peak visibility

Note: Snorkeling here is guided-only. Conditions can cancel it the morning of — have the walk as plan B. Re-enter the park free after the boat. Tours at 08:15 and mid-morning.

BOOKING Required — guided only. Cahuita Experience meets 08:15 at their shop; Wildlife Tours CR \$45 + \$20 pp optional pickup from Manzanillo; Green Cahuita on GetYourGuide (\$49). | W wildlifetours.cr

PAIRS WITH Cahuita National Park — coastal trail; Cahuita village

CULTURE • WELLNESS • TOWN

◇ **Cahuita village** TOWN

1 h · No booking needed

HOURS Daily open all day | **BEST** Oct 10

Sleepy Afro-Caribbean village at the park gate: reggae bars, sodas serving rice-and-beans, one main street.

- Lunch after the park
- The last Caribbean stop before Limón

PAIRS WITH Cahuita National Park — coastal trail; Cahuita National Park — reef snorkel by boat

02 Hone Creek / Bribri

~32 min from Dragonfly / ~42 min from Congo Bongo | 5 entries

NATURE · WATER

• Catarata Finca Two Waters NATURE

~\$4 pp cash · 1.5 h · No booking needed

HOURS Daily 08:00–17:00 | BEST Oct 9

Two waterfalls on a family finca 2 km past Hone Creek on the Bribri road.

- Deep pool with a jump rock on the lower fall
- Lookout over Puerto Viejo and the coast
- Usually empty before 10:00

Note: 1 km steep driveway (fine in the Vitara), then 20–30 min muddy downhill walk; bring water. Cash.

PAIRS WITH Cacao Trails — Museo de Cacao; Kekoldi indigenous family — cacao and exotic animals | OR Catarata Ma-Cu (Bribri "Sparkling" waterfall)

• Catarata Ma-Cu (Bribri "Sparkling" waterfall) NATURE

Ø2,500 pp, includes coffee and fruit · 1 h · No booking needed

HOURS Daily 08:00–17:00 | BEST Oct 9

Family-run falls halfway to Bribri.

- Ten-minute walk down
- Welcoming family
- Coffee and fruit included

Note: Steep and slippery; arrive early for parking at the house. Skip Volio — guided-only and security warnings.

BOOKING None; drive up the family's driveway off Route 36

PAIRS WITH Cacao Trails — Museo de Cacao; Kekoldi indigenous family — cacao and exotic animals | OR Catarata Finca Two Waters

CULTURE · WELLNESS · TOWN

◆ Cacao Trails — Museo de Cacao CULTURE

~\$30–35 pp · 2 h · No booking needed

HOURS Daily 08:00–16:00 | BEST Oct 9

Working cacao garden and small museum at Hone Creek.

- Bean-to-bar walk
- Bribri history
- Wildlife on the property
- You make and taste the chocolate at the end

Note: Ten minutes from the Two Waters turnoff.

BOOKING WhatsApp; ask for Daniel | T +506 8353 8455

PAIRS WITH Catarata Finca Two Waters; Catarata Ma-Cu (Bribri "Sparkling" waterfall); Finca la Isla permaculture farm and botanical garden | OR Kekoldi indigenous family — cacao and exotic animals

◆ Kekoldi indigenous family — cacao and exotic animals CULTURE

Ask · 2 h · **Book ahead** — Confirm by phone before driving

HOURS By arrangement | BEST Oct 9

Small Bribri family operation near Hone Creek: the whole cacao process through to a thick chocolate drink, plus the animals they keep.

- Personal, few visitors

Note: Only two public reviews — confirm by phone before driving. Spanish.

BOOKING Call/WhatsApp (Spanish) | T +506 8580 5253

PAIRS WITH Catarata Finca Two Waters; Catarata Ma-Cu (Bribri "Sparkling" waterfall) | OR Cacao Trails — Museo de Cacao; Kekoldi Reserve — chocolate + waterfall tour (backup)

◆ **Kekoldi Reserve — chocolate + waterfall tour (backup)** CULTURE

From ~\$75 pp · 4–6 h · **Book ahead** — Book online the day before

HOURS Daily 08:00–14:00 | **BEST** Oct 9

Guided version if the family doesn't answer: iguana conservation project, medicinal plants, chocolate, waterfall swim, Caribbean lunch.

- Iguana conservation project
- Medicinal plants and chocolate
- Waterfall swim and Caribbean lunch

Note: Tours ~08:00. Backup only if kekoldi-cacao doesn't answer.

BOOKING Viator / Musement "Indigenous Reserve Chocolate and Waterfalls" | W viator.com/searchResults/all

OR Kekoldi indigenous family — cacao and exotic animals; Cacao Trails — Museo de Cacao

03 **Puerto Viejo**

~18 min from Dragonfly / ~28 min from Congo Bongo | 6 entries

NATURE · WATER

● **Finca la Isla permaculture farm and botanical garden** NATURE

~\$8 self-guided; guided by arrangement · 1.5–2 h · No booking needed

HOURS Mon 10:00–16:00 · Tue–Thu closed · Fri–Sun 10:00–16:00 | **BEST** Oct 5, Oct 9

Spice, fruit, and medicinal-plant garden on the Playa Negra side of Puerto Viejo.

- Vanilla, nutmeg, cinnamon
- Fruit tasting at the end
- Red poison-dart frogs, sloths and toucans on the property

Note: Mud shoes; signs on the self-guided route are faded, so a guide is worth it. Closed Tue–Thu.

BOOKING Call a day ahead for a guided walk | T +506 8886 8530

PAIRS WITH Grow Puerto Viejo; bread what what; La NENA

EAT

■ **Grow Puerto Viejo** EAT

\$\$ · No booking needed

HOURS Mon–Sat 12:00–21:00 · Sun closed | **BEST** Oct 9

Vegetarian/vegan on the Puerto Viejo waterfront.

- Mushroom tacos
- Falafel salad
- Carrot-lox bruschetta
- Smoothies, sea view

Note: Closed Sunday.

PAIRS WITH Finca la Isla permaculture farm and botanical garden; bread what what

■ **Rios Vegan Food** EAT

\$ · No booking needed

HOURS Mon–Fri 08:00–16:00 · Sat 07:00–12:00 · Sun closed | **BEST** Oct 9

Tiny vegan counter in Puerto Viejo.

- Hand-pie empanadas (~€1,800; lentil bolognese, Indian-spiced)
- Croissants
- Banana cake

Note: Takeout — grab for a hike. Sat 07:00–12:00 only; closed Sunday.

PAIRS WITH Catarata Finca Two Waters; Catarata Ma-Cu (Bribri "Sparkling" waterfall); bread what what

■ bread what what EAT

\$\$ · No booking needed

HOURS Mon 08:00–15:00 · Tue closed · Wed–Fri 08:00–15:00 · Sat–Sun 08:00–16:00 | **BEST** Oct 9

Puerto Viejo brunch café.

- Huge sandwiches, banana waffles, açai
- No-sugar juices, strong coffee
- Sloths sometimes visible from the tables

Note: Closed Tuesday. Closes 15:00 on weekdays, 16:00 on weekends.

PAIRS WITH Rios Vegan Food; Finca la Isla permaculture farm and botanical garden; Grow Puerto Viejo

■ Restaurante El Dragon — Asian cuisine & Kung Fu Bar EAT

\$\$ · No booking needed

HOURS Daily 17:00–22:00 | **BEST** Oct 5, Oct 9

Pan-Asian dinner spot on the coast road just past Salsa Brava in Puerto Viejo, with cocktails and kung-fu movies playing in the bar.

4.7★ on Tripadvisor.

- Handmade dumplings and gyoza (veggie ones are the favorite)
- Pad Thai reviewers call the best of their trip
- Fried rice, edamame, sweet-chili veggies
- Vegetarian dishes made vegan on request

Note: Dinner only, opens ~17:00. 200 m south of Super Diamante, after Salsa Brava, left side. Pin and hours are from web listings, not verified on the ground — confirm by phone. Small room; go early.

BOOKING Walk in; call to confirm hours | T +506 6095 4940 · W [instagram.com/thedragon.pv](https://www.instagram.com/thedragon.pv)

PAIRS WITH Finca la Isla permaculture farm and botanical garden; bread what what | **OR** Umi Rojo Beach House (ex-Chile Rojo); Grow Puerto Viejo; La NENA

■ Umi Rojo Beach House (ex-Chile Rojo) EAT

\$\$ · No booking needed

HOURS Mon 17:00–22:00 · Tue closed · Wed 17:00–22:00 · Thu–Fri 17:00–23:00 · Sat–Sun 12:00–23:00 | **BEST** Oct 9

Oceanfront Thai–Japanese fusion with a sushi bar on Puerto Viejo's main street, next to KOKi Beach. Appears to be the long-running Chile Rojo under a new name.

- Sushi rolls and sampler platters with local fish
- Thai seafood soup, sea bass in shrimp-coconut sauce
- Handmade gyoza, Korean wings, dynamite shrimp
- Strong vegan and gluten-free menu
- 2-for-1 cocktail promo most nights

Note: Chile Rojo hours were: closed Tue, dinner-only weekdays, lunch too Sat & Sun. Hours may have changed with the rebrand — call first. Skip the Monday all-you-can-eat buffet night: quality and wait times drop. Main-street location, no dedicated parking.

BOOKING Walk in; call to confirm hours and name | T +506 2750 0421 · W [facebook.com/p/Chile-Rojo-100063453198523](https://www.facebook.com/p/Chile-Rojo-100063453198523)

PAIRS WITH Finca la Isla permaculture farm and botanical garden; Grow Puerto Viejo | **OR** Restaurante El Dragon — Asian cuisine & Kung Fu Bar; Grow Puerto Viejo

04 Playa Chiquita

~9 min from Dragonfly / ~18 min from Congo Bongo | 1 entry

EAT

■ Spicy Coconut EAT

\$\$ · No booking needed

HOURS Daily 12:30–21:30 | **BEST** Oct 6, Oct 7

Beachfront Caribbean-fusion restaurant and cocktail terrace inside Hotel Villas del Caribe in Playa Chiquita, directly across the road from the Jaguar Rescue Center. 4.5★ from 159 reviews.

- Poke bowls, Thai coconut curry, coconut shrimp
- Spicy ceviche and avocado lomito tacos
- Polynesian hot wings, margaritas at sunset
- Sloths in the almond tree over the terrace
- Small boutique of local handmade goods

Note: Lunch and dinner, 12:30–21:30; closed days not published — call to confirm. Busy on weekend nights; reserve by phone. Hotel parking. The natural lunch after the 09:30 Jaguar Rescue tour.

BOOKING Reservations by phone | T +506 2201 7849 · W spicy-coconut.com

PAIRS WITH Jaguar Rescue Center; Masajes Beauty Ritual Spa — couples massage | **OR** La Sirena; SAGE @ Playa 506; Pita & Hummus House

05 Cocles

~10 min from Dragonfly / ~20 min from Congo Bongo | 6 entries

NATURE · WATER

• Jaguar Rescue Center NATURE

~\$24 pp · 2 h · No booking needed

HOURS Daily 09:00–13:00 | **BEST** Oct 6, Oct 7

Wildlife rescue and rehab center in Cocles; small guided groups walk you past sloths, monkeys, toucans, snakes, with each animal's story.

- Guaranteed close sloths
- Volunteers are excellent
- Money goes to releases

Note: Bring repellent; tip the guide. Ten minutes from Dragonfly. Tours at 09:30 and 11:30.

BOOKING Walk in, or reserve online | T +506 2750 0710 · W jaguarrescue.foundation

PAIRS WITH La Sirena; SAGE @ Playa 506; Pita & Hummus House

CULTURE · WELLNESS · TOWN

▲ Masajes Beauty Ritual Spa — couples massage WELLNESS

~\$70 pp / 70 min · 1.5 h · **Book ahead** — WhatsApp a day ahead

HOURS Daily 08:00–21:00 | **BEST** Oct 6, Oct 8

Cocles studio on Calle Ole Caribe, 5.0★ from 110 reviews.

- Couples room
- Foot bath and cold chocolate on arrival
- Chocolate facial at the end
- Reviewers call it the best massage of their trip

Note: Ask about a beach setup vs. studio. Same street as Zaika — pair them.

BOOKING WhatsApp | T +506 8314 8943

PAIRS WITH Zaika Indian Cuisine Bar & Grill

EAT

■ La NENA EAT

\$\$ · No booking needed

HOURS Mon 12:00–20:30 · Tue–Wed closed · Thu–Sun 12:00–20:30 | **BEST** Oct 5, Oct 8, Oct 9

Roadside Caribbean in Cocles.

- Chicken thighs with coconut rice-and-beans
- Oxtail
- Shrimp rice
- House hot sauce

Note: Closed Tue and Wed — Monday night is the natural slot. Vegetarian options are thin.

PAIRS WITH Finca la Isla permaculture farm and botanical garden

■ Zaika Indian Cuisine Bar & Grill EAT

\$\$ · No booking needed

HOURS Mon–Sat 12:00–22:00 · Sun closed | **BEST** Oct 6, Oct 8

Open-kitchen Indian on Calle Ole Caribe.

- Mixed grill
- Fish curry
- Shahi paneer
- Real heat on request, vegan-friendly

Note: Next to the spa. Closed Sunday.

PAIRS WITH Masajes Beauty Ritual Spa — couples massage

■ Pita & Hummus House EAT

\$\$ · No booking needed

HOURS Mon–Sat 07:00–21:00 · Sun closed | **BEST** Oct 7, Oct 8

Family Lebanese on Route 256.

- Homemade falafel, tabbouleh, lamb kebab
- Mojitos
- Strong vegan options
- Parking on site

Note: Closed Sunday.

PAIRS WITH Jaguar Rescue Center

■ SAGE @ Playa 506 EAT

\$\$ · No booking needed

HOURS Daily 08:00–21:00 | **BEST** Oct 7

Beer garden built around a tree on Playa Cocles, sand floor, hammocks.

- The setting
- Avocado toast and juices at breakfast
- A place to sit on the beach with a drink

Note: Food reviews are mixed — go for the spot.

PAIRS WITH Jaguar Rescue Center; Masajes Beauty Ritual Spa — couples massage

06 Punta Uva

~1 min (walkable) from Dragonfly / ~9 min from Congo Bongo | 3 entries

NATURE · WATER

◦ Río Punta Uva kayak + sloth walk WATER

Rental ~\$10 pp/h cash; guided ~\$50–76 pp · 1–2.5 h · No booking needed

HOURS Daily 08:00–17:00 | BEST Oct 6

Paddle up the river that meets the sea at Punta Uva point.

- Sloths, toucans, iguanas, turtles at water level
- Guides add a short walk to the point lookout
- Walking distance from Dragonfly

Note: Go at 08:00 for wildlife and before the wind. Rental is cash.

BOOKING Rental: Kayaks Punta Uva +506 8839 8386. Guided: Green Water Tours +506 6427 7088 (Playa Arrecife), Pachos Place +506 6009 1870. | T +506 8839 8386

PAIRS WITH DIY snorkel at Playa Arrecife / Punta Uva point; La Sirena

◦ DIY snorkel at Playa Arrecife / Punta Uva point WATER

Gear rental ~\$5–10/day · 1 h · No booking needed

HOURS Daily 06:00–17:30 | BEST Oct 6

Shore snorkel around the rocks at the point on a calm morning.

- No boat, no guide, ten minutes from the casita
- La Sirena lunch afterward

Note: Only worth it when the sea is flat.

BOOKING Rent gear from Green Water Tours at Arrecife | T +506 6427 7088

PAIRS WITH La Sirena; Río Punta Uva kayak + sloth walk

EAT

■ La Sirena EAT

\$\$ · No booking needed

HOURS Mon–Sat 11:00–17:00 · Sun closed | BEST Oct 6

On Playa Arrecife, 100 m from Dragonfly. Lunch on a tray on the sand.

- Peruvian-style ceviche (fish or vegetarian)
- Catch of the day in white-wine chimichurri butter
- Spicy shrimp
- They hand you a tray to eat on the sand

Note: Lunch only. Closed Sunday.

PAIRS WITH DIY snorkel at Playa Arrecife / Punta Uva point; Río Punta Uva kayak + sloth walk; Jaguar Rescue Center

07 Manzanillo

~11 min from Dragonfly / ~2 min (walkable) from Congo Bongo | 6 entries

NATURE · WATER

• Gandoca-Manzanillo Wildlife Refuge trail NATURE

Donation · 1.5–4 h · No booking needed

HOURS Daily 06:30–15:00 | BEST Oct 8, Oct 9, Oct 10

Trail from Manzanillo village south along cliffs to hidden coves; Playa Bite at ~1.5 km, Punta Mona at ~5 km.

- Sloths, howlers, poison-dart frogs
- Clifftop viewpoint
- Empty beaches for a swim

Note: Mud — real shoes. Five minutes on foot from Congo Bongo. A 06:30 start on Oct 10 still leaves time for Cahuita.

BOOKING Optional guide at the entrance (~\$30–40 pp) or via Congo Bongo's Caribe Fun Tours link

PAIRS WITH DIY snorkel off Manzanillo beach; Moca Beach Restaurant; Maxi's Restaurant (Manzanillo)

◦ **Sherman's Boat Tour — dolphins, Punta Mona, snorkel** WATER

\$85–110 pp · 3–4 h · **Book ahead** — Ask Daan the day before

HOURS Daily 07:30–17:00 | **BEST** Oct 8, Oct 9

Launch from Manzanillo beach, search for bottlenose and tucuxi dolphins off Gandoca (~85–90% sighting), then a beach break at Punta Mona with snorkeling on the point when conditions allow.

- Punta Mona is boat-or-3-hour-hike only, so you have it nearly alone
- Fresh fruit and pipa on the sand
- The reef has reef sharks and gorges

Note: No pier — you climb in from the beach. Ask him to include the Punta Mona farm walk. Departures ~08:00 and ~13:00.

BOOKING Required. Ask Daan at Congo Bongo to book Sherman directly; backup Rico Tico / Sulariwäk on GetYourGuide (meets by the Manzanillo soccer field). | T +506 8957 4177

PAIRS WITH Punta Mona permaculture farm; Maxi's Restaurant (Manzanillo)

◦ **DIY snorkel off Manzanillo beach** WATER

Gear rental ~\$5–10 · 1 h · No booking needed

HOURS Daily 06:00–17:30 | **BEST** Oct 8, Oct 9

Shallow reef right in front of the village.

- Walk from Congo Bongo
- No booking

Note: Calm mornings only.

BOOKING Rent gear in the village

PAIRS WITH Gandoca-Manzanillo Wildlife Refuge trail; Maxi's Restaurant (Manzanillo)

CULTURE · WELLNESS · TOWN

◆ **Punta Mona permaculture farm** CULTURE

Included in boat combos · 1 h · **Book ahead**

HOURS By arrangement | **BEST** Oct 8

Hundred-acre off-grid farm behind Punta Mona beach.

- Fruit tasting from the orchard
- The story of the place

Note: Do not plan a separate hike-in visit. Only reachable as an add-on to Sherman's boat.

BOOKING Only as an add-on to Sherman's boat; standalone public visits appear dormant

PAIRS WITH Sherman's Boat Tour — dolphins, Punta Mona, snorkel

EAT

■ **Moca Beach Restaurant** EAT

\$\$ · No booking needed

HOURS Mon–Fri 07:00–21:00 · Sat 09:00–17:00 · Sun 07:00–21:00 | **BEST** Oct 7, Oct 8, Oct 9

Jungle-hotel restaurant 2 km before Manzanillo with a path to its own beach.

- Casados, octopus, chicken patacones
- Coconut flan, cocktails
- Monkeys on the beach path

Note: Carry cash — the card machine is unreliable. Sat closes 17:00.

PAIRS WITH Gandoca-Manzanillo Wildlife Refuge trail; DIY snorkel off Manzanillo beach

■ **Maxi's Restaurant (Manzanillo)** EAT

\$\$ · No booking needed

HOURS Daily 11:00–21:00 | **BEST** Oct 8, Oct 9

The village institution by the beach — whole red snapper, lobster, rondón.

- Whole red snapper, lobster, rondón
- Walkable from Congo Bongo, so no driving after drinks

PAIRS WITH Sherman's Boat Tour — dolphins, Punta Mona, snorkel; Gandoca-Manzanillo Wildlife Refuge trail; DIY snorkel off Manzanillo beach

Part II · Day by day

NOTE Anchors are fixed. Option sets are alternatives — pick one, not all.

MON	Oct 5	DRAGONFLY, PUNTA UVA
12:40	Land Limón (Sansa RZ1102) Limón International Airport (LIO).	
13:30	Adobe Rent a Car pickup Bring passport, license, Fidelity card, ARCDW pages.	+506 2758 4042
15:00	Dragonfly check-in ~1h15 drive from Limón. Conf 4W9K5ZP4QB, paid in full.	+506 6128 7817

Land and float

Arrive, swim at Punta Uva beach, dinner at La NENA — the only night it's open before Thursday. El Dragon in town is the backup if you land hungry for Asian.

- La NENA [Cocles]
- Restaurante El Dragon — Asian cuisine & Kung Fu Bar [Puerto Viejo]

Stretch the legs

Finca la Isla on the way through Puerto Viejo (open Mon until 16:00 — tight after a 15:00 check-in, only if the car pickup is fast), then dinner at La NENA.

- Finca la Isla permaculture farm and botanical garden [Puerto Viejo]
- La NENA [Cocles]

TUE	Oct 6	DRAGONFLY, PUNTA UVA
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No fixed times today — the whole day is yours.

WATCH OUT La NENA is closed today (Tue).

Water day

Kayak at 08:00, snorkel the point, lunch on the sand at La Sirena, couples massage at 16:00, dinner at Zaika.

- Río Punta Uva kayak + sloth walk [Punta Uva]
- DIY snorkel at Playa Arrecife / Punta Uva point [Punta Uva]
- La Sirena [Punta Uva]
- ▲ Masajes Beauty Ritual Spa — couples massage [Cocles]
- Zaika Indian Cuisine Bar & Grill [Cocles]

Sloths first

Jaguar Rescue 09:30 tour, lunch at Spicy Coconut across the road (or back to La Sirena), afternoon kayak, dinner at Zaika or Pita & Hummus.

- Jaguar Rescue Center [Cocles]
- Spicy Coconut [Playa Chiquita]
- La Sirena [Punta Uva]
- Río Punta Uva kayak + sloth walk [Punta Uva]
- Zaika Indian Cuisine Bar & Grill [Cocles]
- Pita & Hummus House [Cocles]

Slow day

Bikes from Dragonfly to Playa Chiquita and Cocles, SAGE for a beach afternoon, massage, dinner at Zaika.

- SAGE @ Playa 506 [Cocles]
- ▲ Masajes Beauty Ritual Spa — couples massage [Cocles]
- Zaika Indian Cuisine Bar & Grill [Cocles]

11:00	Dragonfly checkout	+506 6128 7817
16:00	Congo Bongo office closes ~10 min drive from Dragonfly. After 16:00 keys are in the lockbox — confirm the code with Daan.	+506 8957 4177

WATCH OUT La NENA is closed today (Wed).

Cocles morning

Jaguar Rescue 09:30 (if not done Tue), lunch at Spicy Coconut, SAGE or Pita & Hummus, check in, dinner at Moca Beach.

1. ● Jaguar Rescue Center [Cocles]
2. ■ Spicy Coconut [Playa Chiquita]
3. ■ SAGE @ Playa 506 [Cocles]
4. ■ Pita & Hummus House [Cocles]
5. ■ Moca Beach Restaurant [Manzanillo]

Cahuita today instead of Saturday

Leave 07:15, snorkel at 08:15 and/or the coastal walk, lunch in Cahuita village, 50 min south to Congo Bongo before 16:00, dinner at Moca Beach. Frees Saturday for a slow morning.

1. ○ Cahuita National Park — reef snorkel by boat [Cahuita]
2. ● Cahuita National Park — coastal trail [Cahuita]
3. ◇ Cahuita village [Cahuita]
4. ■ Moca Beach Restaurant [Manzanillo]

Straight to Manzanillo

Check in early, short walk in the refuge (closes 15:00), swim, dinner at Moca Beach.

1. ● Gandoca-Manzanillo Wildlife Refuge trail [Manzanillo]
2. ■ Moca Beach Restaurant [Manzanillo]

No fixed times today — the whole day is yours.

Boat day

Sherman's boat at 08:00 with the Punta Mona farm add-on, slow afternoon, dinner at Pita & Hummus (25 min) or walk to Maxi's.

1. ○ Sherman's Boat Tour — dolphins, Punta Mona, snorkel [Manzanillo]
2. ◆ Punta Mona permaculture farm [Manzanillo]
3. ■ Pita & Hummus House [Cocles]
4. ■ Maxi's Restaurant (Manzanillo) [Manzanillo]

Hike day

Refuge trail to Playa Bite or Punta Mona from 06:30, snorkel off the village on the way back, lunch at Moca Beach, massage late afternoon, dinner at Zaika.

1. ● Gandoca-Manzanillo Wildlife Refuge trail [Manzanillo]
2. ○ DIY snorkel off Manzanillo beach [Manzanillo]
3. ■ Moca Beach Restaurant [Manzanillo]
4. ▲ Masajes Beauty Ritual Spa — couples massage [Cocles]
5. ■ Zaika Indian Cuisine Bar & Grill [Cocles]

Do both

Boat at 08:00, short refuge walk after lunch — be back by 15:00.

1. ○ Sherman's Boat Tour — dolphins, Punta Mona, snorkel [Manzanillo]
2. ■ Moca Beach Restaurant [Manzanillo]
3. ● Gandoca-Manzanillo Wildlife Refuge trail [Manzanillo]

No fixed times today — the whole day is yours.

WATCH OUT Inland options are ~35 min from Manzanillo.

Waterfall + chocolate

Breakfast at bread what what, Rios hand pies for the trail, Two Waters or Ma-Cu before 10:00, Cacao Trails (or the Kekoldi family), Finca la Isla in the afternoon, dinner at Grow.

1. ■ bread what what [Puerto Viejo]
2. ■ Rios Vegan Food [Puerto Viejo]
3. ● Catarata Finca Two Waters [Hone Creek / Bribri]
4. ● Catarata Ma-Cu (Bribri "Sparkling" waterfall) [Hone Creek / Bribri]
5. ◆ Cacao Trails — Museo de Cacao [Hone Creek / Bribri]
6. ◆ Kekoldi indigenous family — cacao and exotic animals [Hone Creek / Bribri]
7. ● Finca la Isla permaculture farm and botanical garden [Puerto Viejo]
8. ■ Grow Puerto Viejo [Puerto Viejo]

Puerto Viejo only

bread what what, browse town, Finca la Isla, beach at Playa Negra, dinner in town at Grow, Umi Rojo (sushi) or El Dragon — or La NENA on the way back.

1. ■ bread what what [Puerto Viejo]
2. ● Finca la Isla permaculture farm and botanical garden [Puerto Viejo]
3. ■ Grow Puerto Viejo [Puerto Viejo]
4. ■ Umi Rojo Beach House (ex-Chile Rojo) [Puerto Viejo]
5. ■ Restaurante El Dragon — Asian cuisine & Kung Fu Bar [Puerto Viejo]
6. ■ La NENA [Cocles]

Stay south

Refuge trail or Sherman's boat if not done Thursday, Moca Beach, dinner at Maxi's.

1. ● Gandoca-Manzanillo Wildlife Refuge trail [Manzanillo]
2. ○ Sherman's Boat Tour — dolphins, Punta Mona, snorkel [Manzanillo]
3. ■ Moca Beach Restaurant [Manzanillo]
4. ■ Maxi's Restaurant (Manzanillo) [Manzanillo]

07:00	Settle \$419.51 with Congo Bongo Office opens 07:00. Checkout day.	+506 8957 4177
15:30	Adobe return — Limón downtown Office closes 17:00. Return with a full tank.	+506 2758 4042
16:15	Sansa check-in (LIO)	
17:10	Sansa RZ1132 to SJO Alajuela City Hotel tonight.	

WATCH OUT All bags are in the car at Cahuita — paid lot at Kelly Creek, nothing visible. · Latest departure from Manzanillo direct to Limón: 13:45. · Saturday hours differ: Moca Beach closes 17:00, Rios Vegan closes 12:00.

Cahuita snorkel + walk

Leave 07:00, snorkel at 08:15, 45 min on the coastal trail, lunch in Cahuita village, leave 13:45, Adobe by 14:45.

1. ○ Cahuita National Park — reef snorkel by boat [Cahuita]
2. ● Cahuita National Park — coastal trail [Cahuita]
3. ◇ Cahuita village [Cahuita]

Cahuita walk only

Refuge dawn walk 06:30–08:00, leave 08:45, coastal trail 09:45–12:30, lunch in Cahuita village, leave 13:45.

1. ● Gandoca-Manzanillo Wildlife Refuge trail [Manzanillo]
2. ● Cahuita National Park — coastal trail [Cahuita]
3. ◇ Cahuita village [Cahuita]

Slow exit

Beach morning at Manzanillo, early lunch at Moca Beach (closes 17:00 Sat), leave 13:45 direct to Limón (1h15).

1. ○ DIY snorkel off Manzanillo beach [Manzanillo]
2. ■ Moca Beach Restaurant [Manzanillo]

Part III • What's closed today

KEY ✕ closed ✓ open, no fixed hours ? hours unknown Sorted north to south. Trip dates under each weekday.

PLACE	MON 5	TUE 6	WED 7	THU 8	FRI 9	SAT 10	SUN
CAHUITA							
● Cahuita National Park — coastal trail	8–16	8–16	8–16	8–16	8–16	8–16	8–16
○ Cahuita National Park — reef snorkel...	8–12	8–12	8–12	8–12	8–12	8–12	8–12
◇ Cahuita village	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
HONE CREEK / BRIBRI							
● Catarata Finca Two Waters	8–17	8–17	8–17	8–17	8–17	8–17	8–17
● Catarata Ma-Cu	8–17	8–17	8–17	8–17	8–17	8–17	8–17
◆ Cacao Trails — Museo de Cacao	8–16	8–16	8–16	8–16	8–16	8–16	8–16
◆ Kekoldi Reserve — chocolate...	8–14	8–14	8–14	8–14	8–14	8–14	8–14
PUERTO VIEJO							
● Finca la Isla permaculture farm and...	10–16	✕	✕	✕	10–16	10–16	10–16
■ Grow Puerto Viejo	12–21	12–21	12–21	12–21	12–21	12–21	✕
■ Rios Vegan Food	8–16	8–16	8–16	8–16	8–16	7–12	✕
■ bread what what	8–15	✕	8–15	8–15	8–15	8–16	8–16
■ Restaurante El Dragon — Asian cuisine...	17–22	17–22	17–22	17–22	17–22	17–22	17–22
■ Umi Rojo Beach House	17–22	✕	17–22	17–23	17–23	12–23	12–23
PLAYA CHIQUITA							
■ Spicy Coconut	12:30–21:30	12:30–21:30	12:30–21:30	12:30–21:30	12:30–21:30	12:30–21:30	12:30–21:30
COCLES							
● Jaguar Rescue Center	9–13	9–13	9–13	9–13	9–13	9–13	9–13
▲ Masajes Beauty Ritual Spa — couples...	8–21	8–21	8–21	8–21	8–21	8–21	8–21
■ La NENA	12–20:30	✕	✕	12–20:30	12–20:30	12–20:30	12–20:30
■ Zaika Indian Cuisine Bar & Grill	12–22	12–22	12–22	12–22	12–22	12–22	✕
■ Pita & Hummus House	7–21	7–21	7–21	7–21	7–21	7–21	✕
■ SAGE @ Playa 506	8–21	8–21	8–21	8–21	8–21	8–21	8–21
PUNTA UVA							
○ Río Punta Uva kayak + sloth walk	8–17	8–17	8–17	8–17	8–17	8–17	8–17
○ DIY snorkel at Playa Arrecife / Punta...	6–17:30	6–17:30	6–17:30	6–17:30	6–17:30	6–17:30	6–17:30
■ La Sirena	11–17	11–17	11–17	11–17	11–17	11–17	✕
MANZANILLO							
● Gandoca-Manzanillo Wildlife Refuge...	6:30–15	6:30–15	6:30–15	6:30–15	6:30–15	6:30–15	6:30–15
○ Sherman's Boat Tour — dolphins, Punta...	7:30–17	7:30–17	7:30–17	7:30–17	7:30–17	7:30–17	7:30–17
○ DIY snorkel off Manzanillo beach	6–17:30	6–17:30	6–17:30	6–17:30	6–17:30	6–17:30	6–17:30
■ Moca Beach Restaurant	7–21	7–21	7–21	7–21	7–21	9–17	7–21
■ Maxi's Restaurant	11–21	11–21	11–21	11–21	11–21	11–21	11–21

By arrangement only (no published hours): ◆ Punta Mona permaculture farm · ◆ Kekoldi indigenous family — cacao and exotic animals

Notes

Hours, prices and phone numbers were correct when this guide was generated. Call ahead on anything that matters.